

Pete Crow-Armstrong

24.0 years old
Service Time: 1.117

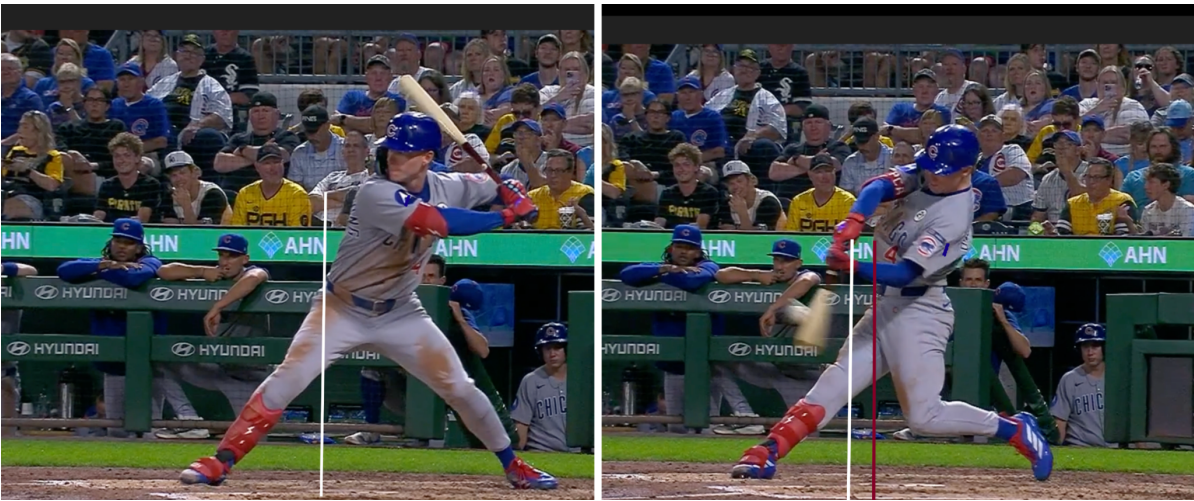
#4
Bats: Left
Throws: Left

G	AVG/OBP/SLG	HR	RBI	SB	BsR	wRC+	DRS	fWAR
146	.281/.375/.574	41	97	36	6.5	158	15	9.9

A BREAKOUT BUILT ON IMPROVED SWING DECISIONS

Crow-Armstrong has taken his game to a whole new level, both offensively and defensively, and has shown a true ability to be an elite 5-tool player for years to come. The jump has made PCA the NL MVP frontrunner, tracking for 10 to 11 fWAR. PCA has increased his batted-ball data and his approach to refine his game. PCA had a wOBA of .323 (.321 xwOBA) in 2025. This year, it jumped to .402 wOBA (.372 xwOBA), going from league-average to elite. PCA’s K% has slightly increased, but his BB% has dramatically increased from 4.5% to 11.5%. The MLB average sits at 8.9% in 2026 and was 8.4% in 2025, indicating an area of his game where PCA went from below-average to significantly above average.

2025 TO 2026 MECHANICAL ADJUSTMENTS



Crow-Armstrong at foot plant and contact, with front-hip rotation reference lines

PCA has made strides in staying more upright during his swing, avoiding collapse of his back leg, and focusing on not pulling off as much. In 2026, PCA refined his swing to sit back more on his back leg, staying more consistent and upright throughout. The white lines show where his front hip started at foot plant, while the red line shows where his front hip finished after rotating. PCA does a fantastic job rotating hard into his hip while keeping his front leg locked. At contact, PCA is providing a great transfer of power from his back hip to his barrel, all without leaking any power, unlike in 2025.

ELITE DEFENDER GETS EVEN BETTER

With 14 DRS in 2025, already at 15 in 2026 and on track for more, is one of the premier center field defenders in baseball. PCA is a data darling, ranking in the 96th percentile for sprint speed, 89th for arm strength, 96th for arm value, and 100th for range and Fielding Run Value (FRV). The advanced metrics also show PCA has an advanced burst (~100th percentile since 2024, with a 4.5-foot jump above average) to pair with an advanced arm that causes runners to advance 3% less than average. The best advantage PCA has is moving laterally, with OAA showcasing 11 OAA moving both towards 3B and 1B.

PCA’s advanced speed, burst, and jumps help him to get to balls in the gap more so than the average. PCA also tends to play a deeper center, meaning the OAA moving back being lower is not unexpected, especially considering the unfriendly wall at Wrigley. The Cubs could also be positioning PCA deeper in center to take advantage of PCA’s sprint speed and jumps on shallow fly balls. PCA is getting better reads than anyone, and it is a major defensive advantage for the Cubs. Crow-Armstrong’s defensive profile provides him a high floor, while his continuing growth surrounding his plate discipline and approach has raised his offensive ceiling.